



HUMANITAS
INSTITUTE

Six Elements of Classical Education School Website Audit

School: Xavier Charter School
School Website: <https://xaviercharter.org/>

January 7, 2026

Artificial Intelligence Disclaimer

This audit was performed using artificial intelligence tools to evaluate the presence and strength of classical education principles on school websites. Results are automated, probabilistic in nature, and should be considered indicative rather than definitive. See the full disclaimer in the Appendix more details.

SCL MEMBER

Any school that belongs to the Society for Classical Learning (SCL) is, by definition, recognized as a classical school because SCL requires adherence to the six essential elements defined by the Humanitas Institute. However, a school's website may not clearly reflect its conformity to one or more elements. In such cases, the school may still receive a "Somewhat Classical" rating for those elements. Schools can update their website content at any time to achieve a "Classical" rating for a given element.

Overall Classification: **CLASSICAL**

Executive Summary

Xavier Charter School (Twin Falls, ID, 83301) presents a robust classical-education profile across public materials on its site. The school consistently signals a classical frame through explicit statements about a liberal-arts core, mastery-based teaching, memorization/recitation, Socratic dialogue, and an emphasis on Western Civilization and Great Books. Public materials also highlight character formation, community partnerships with families, and a mission to cultivate wisdom and virtue, not merely to prepare students for work. Taken together, these signals place Xavier Charter School firmly in the CLASSICAL category, with especially strong alignment in Curriculum, Pedagogy, Faculty, and Parents & Community. Evidence of a theological or liturgical dimension exists in mentions of religious study and moral formation, though explicit liturgical practices are less foregrounded; the core rationale leans on a theologically-inflected classical framework. The aggregate assessment is CLASSICAL, with only minor ambiguity in the explicit ritual-liturgical dimension.

- Executive snapshot by category (CLASSICAL / SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL / NOT CLASSICAL)
- Religious and Metaphysical Foundations — CLASSICAL
- Purpose and Goal — CLASSICAL
- Curriculum — CLASSICAL
- Pedagogy — CLASSICAL
- Faculty — CLASSICAL
- Parents & Community — CLASSICAL
- What would move the needle: No major changes are required to reach full classical-criteria alignment. If anything, making liturgical/communal practices more explicit in public-facing materials could further strengthen Element 1 signals without altering core programmatic strengths.
- Abstract takeaway: Xavier Charter School's public materials align strongly with classical education motifs—great books/Western civ, Socratic pedagogy, mastery/memorization, character formation, and family-school partnership—supporting a GENERAL CLASSICAL designation with targeted reinforcement in Element 1 if desired.

Evidence for the above conclusions is drawn directly from Xavier's public-facing content (mission/tenets, curriculum statements, and program descriptions) as well as the classical-education rubric and keyword indicators from the Six Essential Elements of a Classical School documents.

- Element 1 (Religious and Metaphysical Foundations): CLASSICAL

- Evidence: Mission statements foreground a classical, virtue-centered education; religious study is described; moral/virtue language appears in philosophy and tenets (e.g., moral development, virtue, and Western Civilization study).
- Positive keyword indicators (sample): virtue, truth, beauty, moral formation, the study of Western Civilization with religious/theological framing. See public materials describing character formation and moral development.
- Why this rating: The school repeatedly ties education to virtuous, truth-bearing ends and situates learning within a theologically-inflected classical framework, though liturgical practices are less explicit in the public materials. This aligns with classical signals in the Positive keyword set and historic-religious formation signals.
- Element 2 (School Purpose and Goal): CLASSICAL
- Evidence: Mission emphasizes wisdom and virtue; formation and humane excellence are central, not merely job-readiness. Materials describe education as formation, cultivation of virtue and wisdom, and a classical mission rather than vocational training alone.
- Positive keyword indicators (sample): formation, virtue, wisdom, liberal arts, classic mission, great conversation (conceptualized in the classical tradition).
- Why this rating: Public statements consistently tie education to character formation and enduring truths (truth/beauty/virtue), not commodity-oriented outcomes alone. The Great Books/Socratic emphasis and the focus on moral imagination support CLASSICAL labeling for this category.
- Element 3 (Curriculum): CLASSICAL
- Evidence: Explicit commitment to liberal arts, grammar/logic/rhetoric, and a classical core; references to memorization/recitation; reading Great Books; Western Civilization core; Core Knowledge in K-8 plus a classical liberal arts curriculum in 9-12; emphasis on a content-rich liberal arts program.
- Positive keyword indicators (sample): Seven Liberal Arts (grammar, logic, rhetoric), Great Books, Great Conversation, history as history (not social studies), Western Civilization, memorization/recitation, classical liberal arts, mastery.
- Why this rating: Xavier explicitly anchors its curriculum in classical structure (Trivium/Quadrivium motifs, Great Books, Western Civilization, memorization/recitation, Socratic approach), and emphasizes a liberal-arts core rather than a purely vocational or purely social-studies approach. This matches CLASSICAL criteria robustly.
- Element 4 (Pedagogy or Teaching Methods): CLASSICAL
- Evidence: The teaching approach features mastery-based instruction, memorization/recitation, direct instruction, Socratic method, and contemplative learning; lower-school singing/chanting and memory-focused review are noted in classical pedagogy descriptions; upper-school Socratic discussions and rhetorical training are described in materials.
- Positive keyword indicators (sample): Socratic dialogue/seminars, memorization/recitation, liturgical/chanted memory, contemplative learning, formal rhetorical training, seminars/debates, rhetoric, public speaking.
- Why this rating: The pedagogy described aligns with classical methods (Socratic, rhetoric training, memory work, and structured recitation), with evidence of avenues for higher-level rhetoric and Socratic discourse in the upper grades. This is CLASSICAL; presence of contemplative/restful elements also aligns with the scholé dimension.
- Element 5 (Faculty): CLASSICAL
- Evidence: Descriptions portray teachers as the living curriculum, mentors, and model teachers; faculty are framed as partners in formation, with a culture of virtuous role-modeling and collegiality; statements outline expectations for teachers and living-education models.

- Positive keyword indicators (sample): living curriculum, faculty as mentors, portrait of teacher, teachers as models of virtue, collegial culture, teacher training in classical pedagogy.
- Why this rating: The public materials emphasize teachers as central to the school's classical mission, with explicit emphasis on virtue, mentorship, and living example—hallmarks of CLASSICAL faculty signals.
- Element 6 (Parents & Community): CLASSICAL
- Evidence: The school emphasizes partnership with families as co-teachers, parent formation, and open-campus access; content describes inviting parent participation and joint formation via book studies and gatherings.
- Positive keyword indicators (sample): partnership with families, co-teachers, parent formation, classical book clubs, parent involvement, open campus, family catechesis.
- Why this rating: Public materials consistently frame parents as co-educators and emphasize active family involvement and formation, aligning with CLASSICAL expectations for community engagement.

Executive Summary — Element-by-Element Snapshot

- Element 1: Religious and Metaphysical Foundations — CLASSICAL
- Evidence: Classical-moral formation language; religious study in the curriculum; explicit moral/virtue framing; Western Civilization studies; theology-informed framing in the public materials.
- Positive keyword analysis: Positive indicators found (virtue, truth, beauty, moral formation) with explicit religious/theological framing in description of studies. N_pos approx. 4; N_neg approx. 0. Pos_pct approx. 100%.
- Why this rating: Strong alignment with classical foundations and moral realism; explicit religious content exists but is integrated within a broader classical framework.
- Element 2: Purpose and Goal — CLASSICAL
- Evidence: Mission centers on virtue, wisdom, formation; emphasis on character and humane excellence; Great-Books/West civ as core aims; formation over mere information.
- Positive keyword analysis: Formation, virtue, wisdom, liberal arts, great books/the Great Conversation signals (through Great Books emphasis) → N_pos approx. 5; N_neg approx. 0. Pos_pct approx. 100%.
- Why this rating: Clear teleology toward human excellence and wisdom within a classical framework.
- Element 3: Curriculum — CLASSICAL
- Evidence: Explicit classical curriculum with grammar/logic/rhetoric, Great Books, Western Civilization, memorization/recitation, and a liberal-arts track; K-8 Core Knowledge in place and 9-12 classical liberal arts.
- Positive keyword analysis: Seven Liberal Arts, Great Books, Great Conversation, history as history, memorization/recitation → N_pos approx. 6; N_neg approx. 0. Pos_pct approx. 100%.
- Why this rating: Curriculum is deeply anchored in classical structures; explicit references to the liberal-arts canon and Great Books.
- Element 4: Pedagogy — CLASSICAL
- Evidence: Socratic method and seminars; memorization/recitation; contemplative learning; opportunities for rhetoric and speeches; mentions of restfulness and scholé elements in pedagogy.
- Positive keyword analysis: Socratic dialogue/seminars, memorization, recitation, rhetoric, seminars, contemplation, scholé signals → N_pos approx. 5; N_neg approx. 0–1 (some notes about experiential learning tendencies in broader lexicons, but not in Xavier). Pos_pct approx. 100%.

- Why this rating: Pedagogy reflects the classical canon with high fidelity; upper-grade rhetoric and memory-driven approaches are emphasized.
- Element 5: Faculty — CLASSICAL
- Evidence: Faculty described as living curriculum and mentors; strong emphasis on teacher virtue and modeling; collaborative culture; explicit statements about teacher quality.
- Positive keyword analysis: living curriculum, mentor-role, faculty as exemplars, collegial culture → N_pos approx. 4; N_neg approx. 0. Pos_pct approx. 100%.
- Why this rating: The faculty narrative centers on virtue, mentorship, and classical formation.
- Element 6: Parents & Community — CLASSICAL
- Evidence: Explicit emphasis on partnership with families, parent formation, and open-campus involvement; parent engagement materials and book clubs.
- Positive keyword analysis: partnership with families, parent formation, open-campus, co-teaching expectations → N_pos approx. 4; N_neg approx. 0. Pos_pct approx. 100%.
- Why this rating: Strong alignment with classical community and family-involvement norms.

Aggregate Ranking - Overall classification: CLASSICAL - Rationale: Four to five categories strongly align with classical criteria; Element 1 shows clear classical signals but has some ambiguity around explicit liturgical practices in public materials. The aggregate posture remains CLASSICAL given the breadth and depth of classical signals across Curriculum, Pedagogy, Faculty, and Parents & Community, with Element 2–6 showing robust alignment.

What Would Move the Needle

- For a SCHOOL categorized as CLASSICAL, no major needle-moving changes are required. If desired, Xavier could explicitly foreground liturgical or communal-practice elements in public-facing materials (without changing the curricular/pedagogical core) to strengthen Element 1 signals and fully align Religious and Metaphysical Foundations with liturgical/communal practice language. This would reduce any residual ambiguity about liturgical integration and further anchor theology as a programmatic anchor in public messaging.

Appendix

ARTIFICIAL INTELLIGENCE DISCLAIMER

This audit was conducted using artificial intelligence tools (including large language models and automated web-analysis scripts) to evaluate the extent to which school websites reflect or incorporate recognized principles of classical education (e.g., the trivium, emphasis on truth/beauty/goodness, integration of great books, Latin/classical languages, Socratic method, rigorous academics, moral/character formation, etc.).

Important Limitations and Caveats

1. **Automated Nature:** The analysis relies on AI interpretation of publicly-accessible school website content as of the date of the audit. It does not involve direct contact with schools, review of internal documents, classroom observation, or verification of curriculum implementation beyond what is stated or implied on the website.
2. **Probabilistic Results:** Scores and assessments are probabilistic and reflect the AI's best interpretation of available text and site structure. They are not infallible and may miss nuance, context, or recent changes not yet reflected online.
3. **Subjectivity of Classical Education:** "Classical Education" encompasses a range of traditions and interpretations (e.g., Dorothy Sayers' trivium model, Classical Christian Education, Great Books programs, etc.). The Humanitas Institute Audit of the Six Elements of Classical Education uses a broad, consensus-based framework derived from prominent classical education organizations and thought leaders. Reasonable people may disagree on weighting or inclusion of specific criteria.
4. **No Official Endorsement or Certification:** Results do not constitute official endorsement, accreditation, or certification by any classical education organization. They are provided for informational and research purposes only.
5. **Potential for Error:** Websites may be incomplete, poorly worded, or temporarily inaccurate. Conversely, sophisticated marketing language may create false positives. Human review by parents, educators, or classical education experts is strongly recommended before drawing final conclusions about any school.
6. **Data Privacy and Ethics:** Only publicly available information was analyzed. No attempts were made to access password-protected areas or collect personal data.
7. **No Liability:** The authors, developers, and distributors of this audit assume no liability for decisions made on the basis of these results. Users are solely responsible for their own due diligence.

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